

1. Real World Brand Crisis

Tourism Campaigns and Overtourism in Tokyo

Tokyo has faced increasing pressure from overtourism, especially in highly photographed areas such as Shibuya Crossing, Asakusa, and residential neighborhoods near Mount Fuji viewpoints. Social media played a direct role in driving this issue. Viral posts and travel content exposed specific photo locations, leading to sudden spikes in visitors. In some cases, tourists entered private or restricted areas to recreate popular images. Local residents reported noise, blocked streets, and safety concerns.

A widely reported example involved a residential street near Mount Fuji where tourists crowded the area to capture a specific photo angle. The situation escalated to the point where authorities installed barriers to block the view and limit access. This action showed how online visibility led to real-world disruption. Travel content created demand without considering local impact.

Social media amplified the issue. Platforms such as Instagram and TikTok pushed location-based content to large audiences. Users replicated content quickly. This created crowd surges in areas not designed for high traffic. The spread of content happened faster than local authorities could respond.

Brands and creators often failed to guide behavior. Many posts lacked context about rules, safety, or respect for local communities. This created a gap between inspiration and responsibility. Research shows consumers now influence brand perception and behavior through public reactions and shared content. When audiences react negatively, the impact spreads fast and damages credibility.

The response from authorities focused on control. Barriers, signage, and enforcement increased in affected areas. Some tourism boards began shifting messaging toward responsible travel. The crisis highlights three key points:

- Social media drives physical behavior in real locations
- Exposure of sensitive areas leads to overcrowding
- Lack of guidance leads to unsafe and disruptive actions

This case shows how tourism marketing can create unintended consequences when visibility is not managed.

2. Fictional Brand Crisis (Korpo Travel)

Korpo Travels

Korpo Travels launches a New York campaign promoting “hidden spots across the city.” One post features a specific quiet viewpoint along the High Line during sunrise, presented as a peaceful, uncrowded location. The post gained traction on Instagram and TikTok. Within days, large crowds begin showing up early in the morning to recreate the photo. Local residents and nearby businesses post complaints about noise, congestion, and blocked walkways. Visitors begin climbing over barriers and stepping into restricted areas to match the exact shot. Videos circulate showing unsafe behavior tied directly to the original post. Travel creators and local accounts call out Korpo Travels for exposing a sensitive location and encouraging disruptive behavior. Comments are filled with criticism. Users tag NYC Parks and local authorities. The brand faces pressure to remove the post, issue guidance, and take responsibility for the impact caused by the campaign.

Sources:

- [Japan town blocks view of Mt Fuji at photo spot to stop crowds | Reuters](#)
- <https://krdo.com/news/2024/04/26/overrun-japanese-town-putting-up-eight-foot-barrier-to-block-tourist-photos-of-mount-fuji/>
- [Mount Fuji view to be blocked as tourists overcrowd popular photo spot | Japan | The Guardian](#)
- <https://www.ttgasia.com/2024/04/27/japan-to-construct-barrier-at-mount-fuji-photo-spot-to-comb-at-overcrowding/>